

79 Indefinite pronouns

Indefinite pronouns, such as “anyone,” “someone,” and “everyone,” are used to refer to a person or object, or a group of people or objects, without explaining who or what they are.

See also:

Present simple 1

Forming questions 34

79.1 “ANYONE” AND “SOMEONE”

“Someone” and “somebody” refer to an unspecified person in a positive statement or question.

“Anyone” and “anybody” refer to an unspecified person in a question or negative statement.



Did **anyone** call me this morning?

Yes, **someone** called you at 11 o'clock.



Do you want to talk to **somebody**?

“Somebody” means the same as “someone,” but is more informal.

No, I don't want to talk to **anybody**.

“Anybody” means the same as “anyone,” but is more informal.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Is **someone** working late?



Can **somebody** carry my bag?



I gave **somebody** a flower.



Someone gave me a present.



I didn't give **anybody** your name.



Did **anyone** buy a gift for Mrs. Tan?



I don't know **anyone** in this town.



Did **anybody** here send me this letter?

